April to 13 September 1915. Once again, it was a trial by special tribunal, this time constituted under the Defence of India Act 1925. Forty-two of the 291 convicted conspirators were executed. A majority of 114 got life sentences, and ninety-three were given terms of imprisonment of varying lengths. Only forty-two defendants in the trial were acquitted. One of the hanged was Kartar Singh Sarabha. It is said that Bhagat Singh used to carry a photo of Kartar Singh Sarabha on his person in a locket. If he did do so, it is no surprise, for Bhagat Singh's life was to be not dissimilar to that of Sarabha's.

Sarabha too appeared suddenly on the national stage to leave a tear-drop on the destiny of India. In 1912, Sarabha left Ludhiana in Punjab for San Francisco, where he was radicalized. Entering Berkeley University as an engineering student, he founded the Ghadar Party with other Indians there. When the First World War broke out, the Ghadar Party too declared its *Ailan-i-Jang* on Britain in the form of a declaration of war, following which Sarabha hastened to return to India, where unfortunately he was betrayed, just as Bhagat Singh was by his comrades, by an accomplice in 1915.

After Sarabha was captured, a tribunal was specially convened to sentence him to death in the First Lahore Conspiracy Case.[12] Barely an adult at 19, he was executed on conspiracy charges, much like Bhagat Singh. He was hanged in November 1915. It is often forgotten that he too, like Bhagat Singh, faced death extra-judicially under emergency procedures, and his impact on Bhagat Singh was deep and long-lasting.

Bhagat Singh wrote an article titled 'Bhai Kartar Singh Sarabha' in *Kirti* in its April/May 1927 issue describing him as 'this heroic devotee of the deity of battle' who 'was not even 20 years old when he sacrificed his life' after 'he appeared from nowhere like a whirlwind'. Sarabha, like Bhagat Singh, made the ultimate sacrifice, because 'it was impossible for him to remain unaffected by the events around him'. Bhagat Singh continues, '[h]e was constantly tormented by the question of how the country would attain freedom if the path of non-violence failed.'[13] In April 1927, Bhagat Singh wrote another sketch on Sarabha, where he explains how 'when Kartar Singhji went to America, he went here from slavery' and that 'when he saw